

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<answer>A. The patient is at risk for double depression. </answer>

<think> Reasoning process :

1. **\*\*Duration of feelings of sadness\*\***: The patient has felt sad for as long as he can remember , indicating a long-term pattern of depressive symptoms .
2. **\*\*Hopelessness and loss of interest\*\***: The patient feels hopeless and has difficulty making decisions , which are common symptoms of depression .
3. **\*\*Suicidal ideations\*\***: The patient's mention of worsening suicidal ideations is a significant concern and indicates a risk of suicide .
4. **\*\*Crying for help\*\***: The fact that the patient is seeking help is an important indicator of his willingness to address his mental health concerns .
5. **\*\*Absence of other conditions\*\***: There is no mention of mania , psychosis , or anhedonia , which are common features of other mental health conditions .
6. **\*\*Patient's mood is consistent with depressive mood\*\***: The patient's feelings of sadness and hopelessness , combined with suicidal ideations , suggest a depressive episode .
7. **\*\*Lifetime comorbid conditions\*\***: There is no information about any prior diagnoses or trauma that could be indicative of conditions such as post-traumatic stress disorder ( PTSD ) or other life events that might influence his state of mind .

